

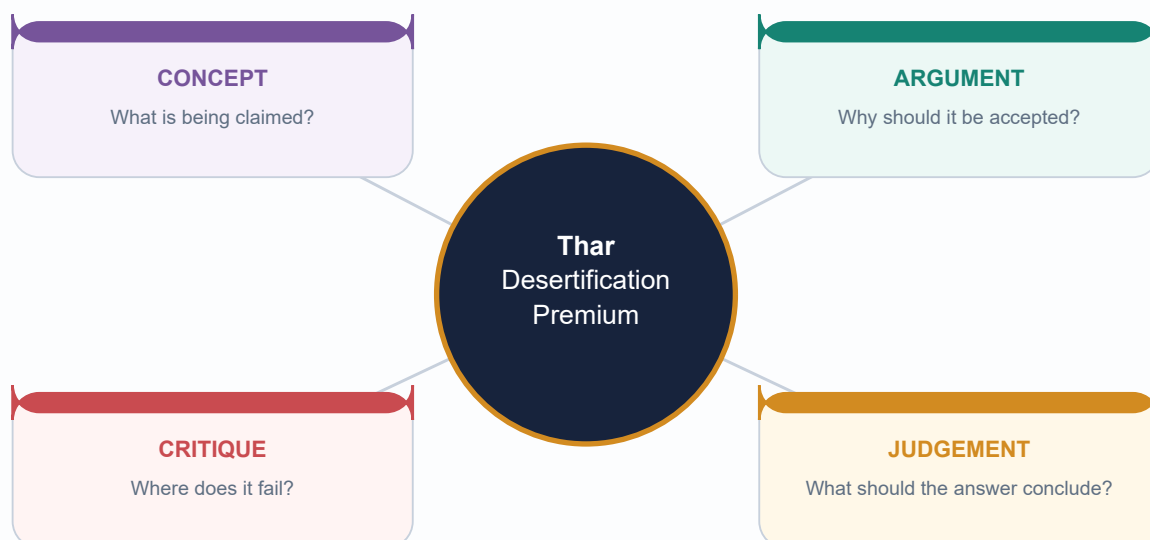
GEOGRAPHY SOLVED PRACTICE WORKBOOK

07 Thar Desertification - Premium Solved Workbook

Complete solved practice companion | Export date: 2026-08-16

Authored MCQ keys rotate A -> B -> C -> D continuously

All Mains solutions follow claim -> evidence -> analysis -> qualification -> verdict.



Facts from official sources | Inferences clearly marked | No fabricated data

HIGH UPSC RELEVANCE

HIGH

Workbook standard, provenance and rotation rule

Solved Practice
Geography

NEWS TRIGGER

Every locally verified relevant PYQ is preserved. Official Prelims keys were not held locally; those solutions are prominently labelled inferred.

INTRO & ORIGIN

PYQ option labels remain faithful to the source and are not rearranged. Strict A -> B -> C -> D rotation applies continuously to the thirty-two authored hard and remedial MCQs.

KEY DATA

Section	Coverage	Validation
Verified PYQs	2020 GS-I; 2018 / 2020 / 2022 Prelims; 2018 CSAT passage set	Local official paper scans
Hard MCQs	24 questions across nearly every subtopic	A-B-C-D repeated six times
Remedial MCQs	8 misconception-targeted questions	A-B-C-D repeated twice
Mains	Two each at 10, 15 and 20 marks	Full model solution and Why this earns marks

STATIC THEORY

- Question logic, option plausibility, answer uniqueness and explanation consistency are checked.
- The workbook contains solutions, not merely answer routes.
- No original question is represented as a UPSC PYQ.

MAINS ANGLE

Use the workbook after one closed-book map-and-definition revision.

STUDY LINK

Companion to the main learning-session PDF.

HIGH

2020 GS-I Q5 - Desertification and climatic boundaries

Verified PYQ
Geography

NEWS TRIGGER

VERIFIED PYQ - local official GS-I scan

INTRO & ORIGIN

The process of desertification does not have climatic boundaries. Justify with examples. (Answer in 150 words)

STATIC THEORY

- [CLAIM] Desertification is best understood as a decline in land productivity and resilience, not as the visible march of a sandy desert.
- [NAMED EVIDENCE] UNCCD formally locates desertification in arid, semi-arid and dry sub-humid areas. Yet the stem's wider process logic is visible in Himalayan slope erosion after forest loss, irrigation-induced salinity in Punjab-Haryana and wind erosion or vegetation degradation in Rajasthan.
- [ANALYSIS] Climate changes the dominant mechanism: intense runoff strips humid slopes; high evaporation converts shallow irrigated water tables into salinity; sparse cover exposes dryland soil to wind. Human land use, hydrology and recovery capacity determine whether stress becomes persistent degradation.
- [QUALIFICATION] In strict convention usage, humid examples are land degradation rather than desertification. A strong answer says this explicitly while accepting the PYQ's broader productivity-loss argument.
- [VERDICT] Therefore degradation crosses climate zones through different pathways; policy must be process-specific rather than based on a moving-desert metaphor.
- Why this earns marks: It directly justifies the proposition, uses named India examples, reconciles the PYQ wording with the UNCCD definition and ends with a graded verdict.

MEMORY HOOK

Preserve source fidelity: never relabel an inferred key as official.

MAINS ANGLE

It directly justifies the proposition, uses named India examples, reconciles the PYQ wording with the UNCCD definition and ends with a graded verdict.

STUDY LINK

Local official question-paper scan.

HIGH**2018 Prelims Q2 - Desert leaf modifications**

Verified PYQ
Geography

NEWS TRIGGER

VERIFIED PYQ - local official Prelims paper; key not held locally

INTRO & ORIGIN

Which leaf modifications occur in desert areas to inhibit water loss? 1. Hard and waxy leaves 2. Tiny leaves 3. Thorns instead of leaves. Options: A. 2 and 3 only; B. 2 only; C. 3 only; D. 1, 2 and 3.

STATIC THEORY

- INFERRED ANSWER — NOT OFFICIALLY VERIFIED: D (1, 2 and 3), high confidence.
- Hard or waxy surfaces reduce cuticular loss; tiny leaves reduce transpiring area; leaves modified into thorns reduce area while green stems may perform photosynthesis.
- Elimination: each listed trait can reduce water loss, so any partial combination is incomplete.
- Why this earns marks: It preserves the official stem, labels the non-official key honestly and explains each adaptation rather than relying on recall.

MEMORY HOOK

Preserve source fidelity: never relabel an inferred key as official.

MAINS ANGLE

It preserves the official stem, labels the non-official key honestly and explains each adaptation rather than relying on recall.

STUDY LINK

Local official question-paper scan.

HIGH**2018 Prelims Q82 - Irrigation and salinisation**

Verified PYQ
Geography

NEWS TRIGGER

VERIFIED PYQ - local official Prelims paper; key not held locally

INTRO & ORIGIN

With reference to agricultural soils: 1. High organic matter drastically reduces water-holding capacity. 2. Soil plays no role in the sulphur cycle. 3. Irrigation over time can contribute to salinization of some agricultural lands. Which are correct? A. 1 and 2 only; B. 3 only; C. 1 and 3 only; D. 1, 2 and 3.

STATIC THEORY

- INFERRED ANSWER — NOT OFFICIALLY VERIFIED: B (3 only), high confidence.
- Statement 1 is false: organic matter generally improves aggregation and water retention. Statement 2 is false: soils store and transform sulphur. Statement 3 is correct where irrigation plus inadequate drainage and evaporation concentrate salts.
- Thar link: the same mechanism explains why a canal can increase production and still create secondary salinity in susceptible command pockets.
- Why this earns marks: It independently verifies all statements and connects the soil mechanism to the IGNP trade-off without claiming that every irrigated field salinises.

MEMORY HOOK

Preserve source fidelity: never relabel an inferred key as official.

MAINS ANGLE

It independently verifies all statements and connects the soil mechanism to the IGNP trade-off without claiming that every irrigated field salinises.

STUDY LINK

Local official question-paper scan.

HIGH**2020 Prelims Q95 - Desert National Park**

Verified PYQ
Geography

NEWS TRIGGER

VERIFIED PYQ - local official Prelims paper; key not held locally

INTRO & ORIGIN

With reference to India's Desert National Park: 1. It is spread over two districts. 2. There is no human habitation inside the Park. 3. It is one of the natural habitats of Great Indian Bustard. Which are correct? A. 2 only; B. 2 and 3 only; C. 1 and 3 only; D. 1, 2 and 3.

STATIC THEORY

- INFERRED ANSWER — NOT OFFICIALLY VERIFIED: C (1 and 3 only), high confidence.
- The park extends across Jaisalmer and Barmer districts and is a Great Indian Bustard habitat. The absolute claim of no human habitation is false.
- Elimination rule: protected-area questions often use an absolute human-exclusion statement as the trap.
- Why this earns marks: It uses two spatial facts and rejects the absolute statement, while clearly separating inferred answer status from official verification.

MEMORY HOOK

Preserve source fidelity: never relabel an inferred key as official.

MAINS ANGLE

It uses two spatial facts and rejects the absolute statement, while clearly separating inferred answer status from official verification.

STUDY LINK

Local official question-paper scan.

HIGH**2022 Prelims Q25 - Lake Faguibine**

Verified PYQ
Geography

NEWS TRIGGER

VERIFIED PYQ - local official Prelims paper; key not held locally

INTRO & ORIGIN

Which lake of West Africa has become dry and turned into a desert? A. Lake Victoria; B. Lake Faguibine; C. Lake Oguta; D. Lake Volta.

STATIC THEORY

- INFERRED ANSWER — NOT OFFICIALLY VERIFIED: B (Lake Faguibine), high confidence.
- Faguibine in Mali is the relevant desiccated-lake example. The other options are not the named West African lake in the stem.
- Concept link: a dried lake surface can result from hydrological and climatic change; it should not be treated as proof that all deserts form by lake desiccation.
- Why this earns marks: It gives the correct geographical identification and prevents an over-generalised origin inference.

MEMORY HOOK

Preserve source fidelity: never relabel an inferred key as official.

MAINS ANGLE

It gives the correct geographical identification and prevents an over-generalised origin inference.

STUDY LINK

Local official question-paper scan.

HIGH

2018 CSAT passage set - Broad desertification usage

Verified PYQ
Geography

NEWS TRIGGER

VERIFIED PYQ PASSAGE - local official CSAT paper; keys not held locally

INTRO & ORIGIN

The passage linked desertification to biological-productivity decline, mountain erosion, irrigation salinity and site degradation. Q27 asked consequences of forest-cover decline; Q28 tested inferences; Q29 tested assumptions.

STATIC THEORY

- INFERRED ANSWER — NOT OFFICIALLY VERIFIED: Q27 D (1, 2, 3 and 4); Q28 A (1 only); Q29 D (neither 1 nor 2), high confidence.
- Q27: the passage directly mentions topsoil loss, smaller-river / spring decline, agricultural harm and groundwater decline.
- Q28: altered river courses follow from the passage; 'human activities only' and the cross-continental monoculture claim overreach.
- Q29: desertification is not tropical-only; 'invariably leads to floods and desertification' is stronger than the passage supports.
- Why this earns marks: It solves from passage language, identifies absolute-word traps and shows why broad CSAT usage still needs definition discipline in GS answers.

MEMORY HOOK

Preserve source fidelity: never relabel an inferred key as official.

MAINS ANGLE

It solves from passage language, identifies absolute-word traps and shows why broad CSAT usage still needs definition discipline in GS answers.

STUDY LINK

Local official question-paper scan.

HIGH

Hard MCQ 1

Prelims Practice
Geography

NEWS TRIGGER

Authored practice. Correct-option rotation is audited A -> B -> C -> D continuously.

INTRO & ORIGIN

Which option best distinguishes desertification from a desert?

- A. Desertification is dryland land degradation; a desert is a climatic region.
- B. Desertification is any temporary rainfall deficit; a desert is permanent drought.
- C. Desertification is wind erosion only; a desert is any sandy land.
- D. Desertification occurs only inside existing desert cores.

STATIC THEORY

- Correct answer: A.
- A is correct. UNCCD desertification is degradation in arid, semi-arid and dry sub-humid areas; a desert is a climatic region.
- Elimination check: reject options that collapse scale, use absolutes, omit the process or transfer a statistic to the wrong geography.

MAINS ANGLE

Convert the explanation into one evidence-linked sentence for a Mains answer.

STUDY LINK

Authored MCQ; not a UPSC PYQ.

HIGH**Hard MCQ 2**

Prelims Practice
Geography

NEWS TRIGGER

Authored practice. Correct-option rotation is audited A -> B -> C -> D continuously.

INTRO & ORIGIN

A district receives near-normal annual rainfall after three dry years, but soil productivity remains depressed because cover and soil structure have not recovered. Which description is best?

- A. Aridity has ended, so degradation is impossible.
- B. The drought may have ended while land degradation persists.
- C. The district has necessarily become a hot desert.
- D. Only aeolian deposition can explain the condition.

STATIC THEORY

- Correct answer: B.
- B is correct. Drought is a temporary anomaly; land condition can remain degraded after rainfall normalises.
- Elimination check: reject options that collapse scale, use absolutes, omit the process or transfer a statistic to the wrong geography.

MAINS ANGLE

Convert the explanation into one evidence-linked sentence for a Mains answer.

STUDY LINK

Authored MCQ; not a UPSC PYQ.

HIGH**Hard MCQ 3**

Prelims Practice
Geography

NEWS TRIGGER

Authored practice. Correct-option rotation is audited A -> B -> C -> D continuously.

INTRO & ORIGIN

Which statement about a barchan dune is correct?

- A. Its horns point upwind and its steep face is windward.
- B. It forms only where vegetation cover is continuous.
- C. Its horns point downwind and its slip face is leeward.
- D. Its long axis must be perpendicular to the dominant wind.

STATIC THEORY

- Correct answer: C.

- C is correct. Barchan horns point downwind; sand climbs the gentler windward slope and avalanches down the lee slip face.

- Elimination check: reject options that collapse scale, use absolutes, omit the process or transfer a statistic to the wrong geography.

MAINS ANGLE

Convert the explanation into one evidence-linked sentence for a Mains answer.

STUDY LINK

Authored MCQ; not a UPSC PYQ.

HIGH**Hard MCQ 4**

Prelims Practice
Geography

NEWS TRIGGER

Authored practice. Correct-option rotation is audited A -> B -> C -> D continuously.

INTRO & ORIGIN

Which sequence best represents episodic water work in an arid basin?

- A. Playa -> glacier -> esker -> fjord
- B. Loess -> delta -> oxbow -> levee
- C. Dune -> moraine -> tarn -> cirque
- D. Wadi -> alluvial fan / bajada -> closed basin -> playa

STATIC THEORY

- Correct answer: D.

- D is correct. Rare intense runoff leaves confined channels, spreads sediment at mountain fronts and may terminate in evaporation-dominated playas.

- Elimination check: reject options that collapse scale, use absolutes, omit the process or transfer a statistic to the wrong geography.

MAINS ANGLE

Convert the explanation into one evidence-linked sentence for a Mains answer.

STUDY LINK

Authored MCQ; not a UPSC PYQ.

HIGH

Hard MCQ 5

Prelims Practice
Geography

NEWS TRIGGER

Authored practice. Correct-option rotation is audited A -> B -> C -> D continuously.

INTRO & ORIGIN

Which regional description of the Thar is the most defensible?

- A. A sandy western core, semi-arid eastern margin, inland drainage and canal-modified northern sectors coexist.
- B. It is a uniform erg extending unchanged from the Aravalli to the Indus.
- C. Its physiography is wholly controlled by the Indira Gandhi Canal.
- D. The Rann is simply the southernmost barchan field of the Thar.

STATIC THEORY

- Correct answer: A.
- A is correct. The Thar is heterogeneous; the Rann is a distinct saline mudflat and marsh context.
- Elimination check: reject options that collapse scale, use absolutes, omit the process or transfer a statistic to the wrong geography.

MAINS ANGLE

Convert the explanation into one evidence-linked sentence for a Mains answer.

STUDY LINK

Authored MCQ; not a UPSC PYQ.

HIGH

Hard MCQ 6

Prelims Practice
Geography

NEWS TRIGGER

Authored practice. Correct-option rotation is audited A -> B -> C -> D continuously.

INTRO & ORIGIN

Why does the Aravalli not generate a major continuous rain belt over western Rajasthan?

- A. It lies entirely north of monsoon influence.
- B. Its trend is broadly parallel to the Arabian Sea monsoon branch, limiting forced ascent.
- C. It is too young to influence airflow.
- D. It blocks only winter monsoon winds from the Bay of Bengal.

STATIC THEORY

- Correct answer: B.
- B is correct. Alignment limits orographic uplift; continentality, subsidence and weak moisture penetration reinforce aridity.
- Elimination check: reject options that collapse scale, use absolutes, omit the process or transfer a statistic to the wrong geography.

MAINS ANGLE

Convert the explanation into one evidence-linked sentence for a Mains answer.

STUDY LINK

Authored MCQ; not a UPSC PYQ.

HIGH

Hard MCQ 7

Prelims Practice
Geography

NEWS TRIGGER

Authored practice. Correct-option rotation is audited A -> B -> C -> D continuously.

INTRO & ORIGIN

Which process most directly explains salt concentration in a Thar playa?

- A. Permanent glacial meltwater inflow
- B. Tidal exchange with the Arabian Sea
- C. Internal drainage followed by strong evaporation
- D. Continuous groundwater flushing

STATIC THEORY

- Correct answer: C.
- C is correct. Closed-basin inflow and high evaporation concentrate dissolved salts.
- Elimination check: reject options that collapse scale, use absolutes, omit the process or transfer a statistic to the wrong geography.

MAINS ANGLE

Convert the explanation into one evidence-linked sentence for a Mains answer.

STUDY LINK

Authored MCQ; not a UPSC PYQ.

HIGH

Hard MCQ 8

Prelims Practice
Geography

NEWS TRIGGER

Authored practice. Correct-option rotation is audited A -> B -> C -> D continuously.

INTRO & ORIGIN

Which statement about the origin of the Thar is most appropriate for a GS-I answer?

- A. A former sea is the settled single cause.
- B. One vanished river created the entire desert at one date.
- C. Only local rock disintegration supplied all sand.
- D. Its evolution is polygenetic, involving climate phases, drainage change, sediment supply and aeolian reworking.

STATIC THEORY

- Correct answer: D.
- D is correct. Multiple evidence streams support a polygenetic and regionally varied evolution.
- Elimination check: reject options that collapse scale, use absolutes, omit the process or transfer a statistic to the wrong geography.

MAINS ANGLE

Convert the explanation into one evidence-linked sentence for a Mains answer.

STUDY LINK

Authored MCQ; not a UPSC PYQ.

HIGH

Hard MCQ 9

Prelims Practice
Geography

NEWS TRIGGER

Authored practice. Correct-option rotation is audited A -> B -> C -> D continuously.

INTRO & ORIGIN

Which pair correctly distinguishes susceptibility from acceleration?

- A. Erratic rainfall is susceptibility; vegetation removal can accelerate erosion.
- B. Mining is susceptibility; aridity is always anthropogenic acceleration.
- C. Canal drainage is susceptibility; drought is always land misuse.
- D. Pastoral mobility is degradation; sandy soil is a restoration measure.

STATIC THEORY

- Correct answer: A.
- A is correct. Climate and substrate create susceptibility, while land-use pressure can increase exposure and slow recovery.
- Elimination check: reject options that collapse scale, use absolutes, omit the process or transfer a statistic to the wrong geography.

MAINS ANGLE

Convert the explanation into one evidence-linked sentence for a Mains answer.

STUDY LINK

Authored MCQ; not a UPSC PYQ.

HIGH

Hard MCQ 10

Prelims Practice
Geography

NEWS TRIGGER

Authored practice. Correct-option rotation is audited A -> B -> C -> D continuously.

INTRO & ORIGIN

Which chain best explains secondary salinity in a poorly drained canal command?

- A. Drainage -> deeper water table -> salt removal -> salinity
- B. Seepage / return flow -> shallow water table -> capillary rise and evaporation -> salt accumulation
- C. Wind deposition -> glacier formation -> salt accumulation
- D. Afforestation -> lower evapotranspiration -> salt accumulation

STATIC THEORY

- Correct answer: B.
- B is correct. The water table rises, dissolved salts move upward and evaporation concentrates them near the root zone.
- Elimination check: reject options that collapse scale, use absolutes, omit the process or transfer a statistic to the wrong geography.

MAINS ANGLE

Convert the explanation into one evidence-linked sentence for a Mains answer.

STUDY LINK

Authored MCQ; not a UPSC PYQ.

HIGH

Hard MCQ 11

Prelims Practice
Geography

NEWS TRIGGER

Authored practice. Correct-option rotation is audited A -> B -> C -> D continuously.

INTRO & ORIGIN

Which example best supports the proposition that degradation is not synonymous with desert expansion?

- A. A barchan migrates within an uninhabited sand sea.
- B. A dust storm crosses a state boundary.
- C. Irrigated land loses productivity through waterlogging and salinity without dune advance.
- D. A desert station records a high daytime temperature.

STATIC THEORY

- Correct answer: C.
- C is correct. Productivity can decline through hydrological and chemical processes without a moving sand front.
- Elimination check: reject options that collapse scale, use absolutes, omit the process or transfer a statistic to the wrong geography.

MAINS ANGLE

Convert the explanation into one evidence-linked sentence for a Mains answer.

STUDY LINK

Authored MCQ; not a UPSC PYQ.

HIGH

Hard MCQ 12

Prelims Practice
Geography

NEWS TRIGGER

Authored practice. Correct-option rotation is audited A -> B -> C -> D continuously.

INTRO & ORIGIN

Which statement accurately uses SAC's Rajasthan 2018-19 results?

- A. Wind erosion affected 62.06% and total DLD affected 43.37% of TGA.
- B. Rajasthan's DLD increased from 62.90% to 63.19% in 2018-19.
- C. The Atlas proves every district improved.
- D. Total DLD was 62.06% of TGA; wind erosion was 43.37%, with a modest total decline from 2011-13.

STATIC THEORY

- Correct answer: D.
- D is correct. It preserves denominator, date, process and trend; it does not claim uniform district recovery.
- Elimination check: reject options that collapse scale, use absolutes, omit the process or transfer a statistic to the wrong geography.

MAINS ANGLE

Convert the explanation into one evidence-linked sentence for a Mains answer.

STUDY LINK

Authored MCQ; not a UPSC PYQ.

HIGH

Hard MCQ 13

Prelims Practice
Geography

NEWS TRIGGER

Authored practice. Correct-option rotation is audited A -> B -> C -> D continuously.

INTRO & ORIGIN

What is the most balanced assessment of the Indira Gandhi Canal?

- A. It relaxed water constraints and transformed livelihoods, but sustainability depends on drainage, crop-water fit, equity and ecosystem condition.
- B. It completely ended desertification across western Rajasthan.
- C. It was an ecological failure because all irrigation in deserts is harmful.
- D. It affects agriculture but not hydrology or settlement.

STATIC THEORY

- Correct answer: A.
- A is correct. The canal produced benefits and differentiated trade-offs; a binary success-failure verdict is inadequate.
- Elimination check: reject options that collapse scale, use absolutes, omit the process or transfer a statistic to the wrong geography.

MAINS ANGLE

Convert the explanation into one evidence-linked sentence for a Mains answer.

STUDY LINK

Authored MCQ; not a UPSC PYQ.

HIGH

Hard MCQ 14

Prelims Practice
Geography

NEWS TRIGGER

Authored practice. Correct-option rotation is audited A -> B -> C -> D continuously.

INTRO & ORIGIN

Which inference about Aravalli degradation is evidence-bounded?

- A. Every mined gap causes a fixed annual eastward desert advance.
- B. Loss of relief and vegetation can weaken local wind, water, soil and habitat functions.
- C. The Aravalli creates all rainfall in Rajasthan.
- D. Restoration can rely on a concrete wall instead of landscape management.

STATIC THEORY

- Correct answer: B.
- B is correct. It identifies plausible ecological functions without asserting an unsupported desert-front rate.
- Elimination check: reject options that collapse scale, use absolutes, omit the process or transfer a statistic to the wrong geography.

MAINS ANGLE

Convert the explanation into one evidence-linked sentence for a Mains answer.

STUDY LINK

Authored MCQ; not a UPSC PYQ.

HIGH

Hard MCQ 15

Prelims Practice
Geography

NEWS TRIGGER

Authored practice. Correct-option rotation is audited A -> B -> C -> D continuously.

INTRO & ORIGIN

Which is a defensible native-species restoration set for the Thar?

- A. Water hyacinth, rubber and spruce
- B. Only Prosopis juliflora monoculture
- C. Khejri, rohida, phog, khimp and sewan grass
- D. Mangrove, teak and alpine fir

STATIC THEORY

- Correct answer: C.
- C is correct. The set contains arid-region native or characteristic species; Prosopis juliflora is introduced.
- Elimination check: reject options that collapse scale, use absolutes, omit the process or transfer a statistic to the wrong geography.

MAINS ANGLE

Convert the explanation into one evidence-linked sentence for a Mains answer.

STUDY LINK

Authored MCQ; not a UPSC PYQ.

HIGH

Hard MCQ 16

Prelims Practice
Geography

NEWS TRIGGER

Authored practice. Correct-option rotation is audited A -> B -> C -> D continuously.

INTRO & ORIGIN

What is the correct LDN response hierarchy?

- A. Reverse -> reduce -> avoid
- B. Offset -> ignore -> restore
- C. Plant -> irrigate -> report
- D. Avoid -> reduce -> reverse

STATIC THEORY

- Correct answer: D.
- D is correct. Prevention and reduction have priority over repairing past degradation.
- Elimination check: reject options that collapse scale, use absolutes, omit the process or transfer a statistic to the wrong geography.

MAINS ANGLE

Convert the explanation into one evidence-linked sentence for a Mains answer.

STUDY LINK

Authored MCQ; not a UPSC PYQ.

HIGH

Hard MCQ 17

Prelims Practice
Geography

NEWS TRIGGER

Authored practice. Correct-option rotation is audited A -> B -> C -> D continuously.

INTRO & ORIGIN

Which set contains the three minimum UNCCD land-based LDN indicators?

- A. Land-cover change, land productivity and soil organic carbon
- B. Tree count, rainfall and canal length
- C. Livestock number, temperature and population
- D. Only NDVI, with no field interpretation

STATIC THEORY

- Correct answer: A.
- A is correct. Additional local indicators should supplement the minimum core set.
- Elimination check: reject options that collapse scale, use absolutes, omit the process or transfer a statistic to the wrong geography.

MAINS ANGLE

Convert the explanation into one evidence-linked sentence for a Mains answer.

STUDY LINK

Authored MCQ; not a UPSC PYQ.

HIGH

Hard MCQ 18

Prelims Practice
Geography

NEWS TRIGGER

Authored practice. Correct-option rotation is audited A -> B -> C -> D continuously.

INTRO & ORIGIN

Which restoration design best fits a mobile dune threatening fields?

- A. Deep flooding of the dune throughout the year
- B. Temporary mechanical barriers followed by native grasses, shrubs, suitable trees and grazing control
- C. Removing all vegetation so sand can move freely
- D. A dense water-intensive exotic plantation without survival monitoring

STATIC THEORY

- Correct answer: B.
- B is correct. Stabilisation requires reducing near-surface wind, establishing cover and controlling disturbance with ecological fit.
- Elimination check: reject options that collapse scale, use absolutes, omit the process or transfer a statistic to the wrong geography.

MAINS ANGLE

Convert the explanation into one evidence-linked sentence for a Mains answer.

STUDY LINK

Authored MCQ; not a UPSC PYQ.

HIGH**Hard MCQ 19**

Prelims Practice
Geography

NEWS TRIGGER

Authored practice. Correct-option rotation is audited A -> B -> C -> D continuously.

INTRO & ORIGIN

Which action most directly addresses pasture degradation as a commons-governance problem?

- A. Permanent exclusion of all users without alternatives
- B. Replacing pasture with a canal reservoir
- C. Agreed rotational access, recovery periods, fodder planning and community monitoring
- D. Counting saplings outside the grazing area

STATIC THEORY

- Correct answer: C.
- C is correct. Rules, timing, legitimacy and livelihood alternatives address concentrated pressure.
- Elimination check: reject options that collapse scale, use absolutes, omit the process or transfer a statistic to the wrong geography.

MAINS ANGLE

Convert the explanation into one evidence-linked sentence for a Mains answer.

STUDY LINK

Authored MCQ; not a UPSC PYQ.

HIGH**Hard MCQ 20**

Prelims Practice
Geography

NEWS TRIGGER

Authored practice. Correct-option rotation is audited A -> B -> C -> D continuously.

INTRO & ORIGIN

Which statement about groundwater stress in the Thar is most accurate?

- A. All groundwater is fresh and annually renewable.
- B. Canal water automatically recharges every aquifer sustainably.
- C. Falling water tables alone prove rainfall decline.
- D. Quantity, salinity, recharge, pumping and canal interactions vary spatially and must be jointly assessed.

STATIC THEORY

- Correct answer: D.
- D is correct. Groundwater risk is a spatial water-balance and quality problem.
- Elimination check: reject options that collapse scale, use absolutes, omit the process or transfer a statistic to the wrong geography.

MAINS ANGLE

Convert the explanation into one evidence-linked sentence for a Mains answer.

STUDY LINK

Authored MCQ; not a UPSC PYQ.

HIGH**Hard MCQ 21**

Prelims Practice
Geography

NEWS TRIGGER

Authored practice. Correct-option rotation is audited A -> B -> C -> D continuously.

INTRO & ORIGIN

Which transport-mode statement is correct?

- A. Suspension carries fine dust far; saltation bounces sand; creep moves coarser grains.
- B. Suspension moves only boulders; saltation moves dissolved salts.
- C. Creep is atmospheric dust transport.
- D. All three modes require flowing water.

STATIC THEORY

- Correct answer: A.
- A is correct. The three modes differ mainly by grain size and movement.
- Elimination check: reject options that collapse scale, use absolutes, omit the process or transfer a statistic to the wrong geography.

MAINS ANGLE

Convert the explanation into one evidence-linked sentence for a Mains answer.

STUDY LINK

Authored MCQ; not a UPSC PYQ.

HIGH**Hard MCQ 22**

Prelims Practice
Geography

NEWS TRIGGER

Authored practice. Correct-option rotation is audited A -> B -> C -> D continuously.

INTRO & ORIGIN

Which feedback most plausibly locks a dryland into degradation?

- A. More cover -> more infiltration -> recovery
- B. Cover loss -> erosion -> lower fodder / yield -> greater pressure on remaining land
- C. Drainage -> lower water table -> reduced salinity
- D. Pasture rest -> seed recovery -> higher resilience

STATIC THEORY

- Correct answer: B.
- B is correct. Biophysical decline and livelihood pressure can reinforce one another.
- Elimination check: reject options that collapse scale, use absolutes, omit the process or transfer a statistic to the wrong geography.

MAINS ANGLE

Convert the explanation into one evidence-linked sentence for a Mains answer.

STUDY LINK

Authored MCQ; not a UPSC PYQ.

HIGH**Hard MCQ 23**

Prelims Practice
Geography

NEWS TRIGGER

Authored practice. Correct-option rotation is audited A -> B -> C -> D continuously.

INTRO & ORIGIN

Which statement correctly distinguishes salinity from waterlogging?

- A. They are identical terms.
- B. Salinity can occur only in coastal deltas.
- C. Waterlogging is excess water in the root zone; salinity is harmful salt accumulation, though the two can interact.
- D. Waterlogging always lowers the water table.

STATIC THEORY

- Correct answer: C.
- C is correct. Shallow waterlogging and evaporation can contribute to salinity, but the conditions are analytically distinct.
- Elimination check: reject options that collapse scale, use absolutes, omit the process or transfer a statistic to the wrong geography.

MAINS ANGLE

Convert the explanation into one evidence-linked sentence for a Mains answer.

STUDY LINK

Authored MCQ; not a UPSC PYQ.

HIGH**Hard MCQ 24**

Prelims Practice
Geography

NEWS TRIGGER

Authored practice. Correct-option rotation is audited A -> B -> C -> D continuously.

INTRO & ORIGIN

Which current-affairs statement was valid on 16 August 2026?

- A. COP17 had already adopted its final decisions.
- B. UNCCD published a new 2026 Rajasthan degradation percentage.
- C. Desertification and Drought Day 2026 focused only on urban forests.
- D. COP17 was scheduled for 17-28 August in Ulaanbaatar, while the 2026 Day foregrounded rangelands.

STATIC THEORY

- Correct answer: D.
- D is correct. It respects the retrieval boundary and does not invent conference outcomes.
- Elimination check: reject options that collapse scale, use absolutes, omit the process or transfer a statistic to the wrong geography.

MAINS ANGLE

Convert the explanation into one evidence-linked sentence for a Mains answer.

STUDY LINK

Authored MCQ; not a UPSC PYQ.

HIGH**Remedial MCQ 25**

Prelims Practice
Geography

NEWS TRIGGER

Authored practice. Correct-option rotation is audited A -> B -> C -> D continuously.

INTRO & ORIGIN

A satellite image shows more vegetation in an irrigated desert tract. What can be concluded immediately?

- A. Only that vegetation signal increased; groundwater, salinity, native ecology and durability still require evidence.
- B. Land degradation neutrality has definitely been achieved.
- C. The area is no longer arid.
- D. Waterlogging is impossible.

STATIC THEORY

- Correct answer: A.
- A is correct. Greening is one observation, not a complete restoration verdict.
- Elimination check: reject options that collapse scale, use absolutes, omit the process or transfer a statistic to the wrong geography.

MAINS ANGLE

Convert the explanation into one evidence-linked sentence for a Mains answer.

STUDY LINK

Authored MCQ; not a UPSC PYQ.

HIGH**Remedial MCQ 26**

Prelims Practice
Geography

NEWS TRIGGER

Authored practice. Correct-option rotation is audited A -> B -> C -> D continuously.

INTRO & ORIGIN

Which drainage association is most appropriate?

- A. Luni is a perennial Himalayan tributary of the Ganga.
- B. Luni is the principal Thar inland-drainage cue, while Ghaggar water may dissipate in plains and depressions.
- C. Every Thar stream reaches the Arabian Sea throughout the year.
- D. Playas are tidal estuaries.

STATIC THEORY

- Correct answer: B.
- B is correct. The region has ephemeral and internal drainage, with strong losses to infiltration and evaporation.
- Elimination check: reject options that collapse scale, use absolutes, omit the process or transfer a statistic to the wrong geography.

MAINS ANGLE

Convert the explanation into one evidence-linked sentence for a Mains answer.

STUDY LINK

Authored MCQ; not a UPSC PYQ.

HIGH**Remedial MCQ 27**

Prelims Practice
Geography

NEWS TRIGGER

Authored practice. Correct-option rotation is audited A -> B -> C -> D continuously.

INTRO & ORIGIN

Which proposal most clearly violates ecological-fit principles?

- A. Native grass recovery on a gochar
- B. Drainage and crop correction in a saline canal pocket
- C. A single water-intensive exotic tree monoculture across natural open desert grassland
- D. Khadin repair with catchment maintenance

STATIC THEORY

- Correct answer: C.
- C is correct. It ignores ecosystem type, water balance, biodiversity and livelihood function.
- Elimination check: reject options that collapse scale, use absolutes, omit the process or transfer a statistic to the wrong geography.

MAINS ANGLE

Convert the explanation into one evidence-linked sentence for a Mains answer.

STUDY LINK

Authored MCQ; not a UPSC PYQ.

HIGH**Remedial MCQ 28**

Prelims Practice
Geography

NEWS TRIGGER

Authored practice. Correct-option rotation is audited A -> B -> C -> D continuously.

INTRO & ORIGIN

Which verdict on the Indira Gandhi Canal should be rejected?

- A. Benefits and costs vary across reaches and soils.
- B. Drainage and crop choice affect sustainability.
- C. Irrigation can green land and still create salinity risk.
- D. It is either a complete success or a complete failure everywhere.

STATIC THEORY

- Correct answer: D.
- D is correct. A binary region-wide verdict ignores spatially differentiated outcomes.
- Elimination check: reject options that collapse scale, use absolutes, omit the process or transfer a statistic to the wrong geography.

MAINS ANGLE

Convert the explanation into one evidence-linked sentence for a Mains answer.

STUDY LINK

Authored MCQ; not a UPSC PYQ.

HIGH**Remedial MCQ 29**

Prelims Practice
Geography

NEWS TRIGGER

Authored practice. Correct-option rotation is audited A -> B -> C -> D continuously.

INTRO & ORIGIN

Which was India's largest mapped land-degradation process nationally in SAC's 2018-19 assessment?

- A. Water erosion
- B. Wind erosion
- C. Waterlogging
- D. Frost shattering

STATIC THEORY

- Correct answer: A.
- A is correct. Water erosion was 11.01% of TGA, ahead of vegetation degradation and wind erosion.
- Elimination check: reject options that collapse scale, use absolutes, omit the process or transfer a statistic to the wrong geography.

MAINS ANGLE

Convert the explanation into one evidence-linked sentence for a Mains answer.

STUDY LINK

Authored MCQ; not a UPSC PYQ.

HIGH**Remedial MCQ 30**

Prelims Practice
Geography

NEWS TRIGGER

Authored practice. Correct-option rotation is audited A -> B -> C -> D continuously.

INTRO & ORIGIN

Which Rajasthan statistic is correctly stated for the SAC 2018-19 timeframe?

- A. Wind erosion was 62.06% of TGA.
- B. Wind erosion was 43.37% of TGA.
- C. Waterlogging was the dominant process.
- D. The total DLD share was 29.77%.

STATIC THEORY

- Correct answer: B.
- B is correct. Rajasthan total DLD was 62.06%; 29.77% was the all-India total.
- Elimination check: reject options that collapse scale, use absolutes, omit the process or transfer a statistic to the wrong geography.

MAINS ANGLE

Convert the explanation into one evidence-linked sentence for a Mains answer.

STUDY LINK

Authored MCQ; not a UPSC PYQ.

HIGH**Remedial MCQ 31**

Prelims Practice
Geography

NEWS TRIGGER

Authored practice. Correct-option rotation is audited A -> B -> C -> D continuously.

INTRO & ORIGIN

What is the strongest Thar linkage of the 2026 rangelands agenda?

- A. Replace all pastoralism with settled rice cultivation.
- B. Measure only tree cover.
- C. Restore native pasture while supporting grazing governance, drought resilience and pastoral livelihoods.
- D. Use the global rangeland statistic as a Rajasthan estimate.

STATIC THEORY

- Correct answer: C.
- C is correct. The linkage is community-centred rangeland health, not statistical transfer or land-use homogenisation.
- Elimination check: reject options that collapse scale, use absolutes, omit the process or transfer a statistic to the wrong geography.

MAINS ANGLE

Convert the explanation into one evidence-linked sentence for a Mains answer.

STUDY LINK

Authored MCQ; not a UPSC PYQ.

HIGH**Remedial MCQ 32**

Prelims Practice
Geography

NEWS TRIGGER

Authored practice. Correct-option rotation is audited A -> B -> C -> D continuously.

INTRO & ORIGIN

Which final paragraph is most examiner-grade?

- A. The government should take steps.
- B. Plantation will solve everything.
- C. The desert must be stopped at all costs.
- D. A process-matched, community-governed and indicator-tracked strategy can protect land function while preserving dryland livelihoods.

STATIC THEORY

- Correct answer: D.
- D is correct. It contains mechanism, institution, monitoring and a balanced objective.
- Elimination check: reject options that collapse scale, use absolutes, omit the process or transfer a statistic to the wrong geography.

MAINS ANGLE

Convert the explanation into one evidence-linked sentence for a Mains answer.

STUDY LINK

Authored MCQ; not a UPSC PYQ.

HIGH**Original 10-marker 1 - Desert versus desertification**

10 marks | 150

words

Geography

NEWS TRIGGER

Original practice - examiner-oriented model answer using claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification -> verdict.

INTRO & ORIGIN

Distinguish desert, aridity, drought and desertification. Why does this distinction matter for dryland policy in India?

STATIC THEORY

- [CLAIM] The four terms operate at different analytical levels: desert is a climatic region, aridity a long-term moisture balance, drought a temporary anomaly and desertification persistent degradation in drylands.
- [NAMED EVIDENCE] UNCCD's dryland definition separates desertification from broader land degradation. Rajasthan's Thar can remain a functional desert, while an irrigated command pocket can lose productivity through salinity. Conversely, a drought year need not create lasting degradation if cover and institutions recover.
- [ANALYSIS] The distinction changes policy. Drought requires preparedness and relief; chronic aridity requires water-efficient livelihoods; wind erosion needs cover and surface protection; irrigation salinity needs drainage and conjunctive use. Treating all as 'desert spread' produces tree-planting or water-supply solutions that may miss the process.
- [QUALIFICATION] Terms are used loosely in public debate, so an answer may acknowledge broader site-degradation usage while retaining the convention definition.
- [VERDICT] Precision converts a slogan into process-matched policy.
- Why this earns marks: It defines all four terms, uses a Thar and canal example, shows the policy consequence of the distinction and includes a terminology qualification.

MAINS ANGLE

It defines all four terms, uses a Thar and canal example, shows the policy consequence of the distinction and includes a terminology qualification.

STUDY LINK

Original practice; not claimed as a UPSC PYQ.

HIGH

Original 10-marker 2 - Thar landform system

10 marks | 150

words

Geography

NEWS TRIGGER

Original practice - examiner-oriented model answer using claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification -> verdict.

INTRO & ORIGIN

Explain how wind and episodic water together shape the Thar landscape.

STATIC THEORY

- [CLAIM] The Thar is a coupled aeolian-fluvial landscape rather than an endless wind-built sand sea.
- [NAMED EVIDENCE] Wind deflates loose fines, abrades near the ground and moves sediment by suspension, saltation and creep, building barchans, longitudinal dunes and sand sheets. Around the Aravalli and rocky margins, cloudburst runoff moves through wadis, forms alluvial fans and pediments and terminates in interdunal or closed basins such as playa-salt-lake systems.
- [ANALYSIS] Interdunes receive runoff and support grazing or cultivation; strong evaporation can concentrate salts. Vegetation stabilises some dunes, while disturbance can reactivate them. The Luni supplies the main inland-drainage map cue.
- [QUALIFICATION] Not every dune is active and not every salt basin has the same origin.
- [VERDICT] The diagnostic answer is a wind-water sequence linked to subregional relief and drainage.
- Why this earns marks: It explains processes, names landforms and a river, adds a stabilisation insight and avoids wind-only determinism.

MAINS ANGLE

It explains processes, names landforms and a river, adds a stabilisation insight and avoids wind-only determinism.

STUDY LINK

Original practice; not claimed as a UPSC PYQ.

HIGH

Original 15-marker 1 - Aravalli and Thar risk

15 marks | 250

words

Geography

NEWS TRIGGER

Original practice - examiner-oriented model answer using claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification -> verdict.

INTRO & ORIGIN

Assess the ecological significance of the Aravalli for limiting land degradation around the Thar. Avoid a simplistic barrier narrative.

STATIC THEORY

- [CLAIM] The Aravalli is significant less as a literal wall than as a landscape system supplying roughness, catchment, soil and habitat functions.
- [NAMED EVIDENCE] Its broad alignment parallel to the Arabian Sea monsoon branch explains why it does not create a continuous western rain belt. Yet vegetated relief can reduce near-surface wind locally, route runoff, support recharge, retain soil and connect dry-forest and scrub habitats. MoEFCC's 2023 Aravalli Green Wall brief accordingly combines a 5 km restoration buffer with afforestation, water conservation and water-body restoration across four states.
- [ANALYSIS] Mining, clearing and fragmentation may remove vegetation and relief, accelerate runoff and sediment, increase local dust exposure and weaken habitat connectivity. These changes can reduce resilience on the semi-arid Thar margin. Restoration therefore needs catchment repair, native vegetation, regulated extraction, corridor protection and local livelihoods rather than only plantation counts.
- [QUALIFICATION] There is no defensible basis here for a fixed desert-advance rate or for claiming that one breach mechanically carries the Thar eastward. Effects vary with wind, soils, land use and scale.
- [VERDICT] Protecting the Aravalli is a regional land-water-biodiversity strategy; its strongest justification is ecosystem function, not a magical-wall metaphor.
- Why this earns marks: It answers 'assess', uses monsoon geometry and an official programme, gives four functions, explains degradation pathways and explicitly limits the claim.

MAINS ANGLE

It answers 'assess', uses monsoon geometry and an official programme, gives four functions, explains degradation pathways and explicitly limits the claim.

STUDY LINK

Original practice; not claimed as a UPSC PYQ.

HIGH**Original 15-marker 2 - Canal transformation**

15 marks | 250
words
Geography

NEWS TRIGGER

Original practice - examiner-oriented model answer using claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification -> verdict.

INTRO & ORIGIN

The Indira Gandhi Canal transformed the Thar but also relocated environmental risk. Discuss.

STATIC THEORY

- [CLAIM] IGNP relaxed a fundamental water constraint and enabled irrigation, settlement, drinking-water support and diversified markets, but it also altered the desert water balance.
- [NAMED EVIDENCE] CGWB's Ganganagar profile describes extensive canal irrigation and records waterlogging in IGNP command pockets where seepage and return flow meet shallow low-permeability layers, interdunal depressions and weak natural drainage. It also records wide groundwater-salinity variation and recommends conjunctive use, suitable abstraction wells, micro-irrigation, crop correction, bio-drainage and reclamation.
- [ANALYSIS] Thus canal water can stabilise dunes and increase biomass while raising water tables; high evaporation then concentrates salts in the root zone. High-water-demand crops, head-tail inequality and maintenance gaps can magnify the problem. Ecologically, irrigated greening can also replace native open habitats and modify disease-vector or wildlife conditions.
- [QUALIFICATION] These effects are not uniform across the whole command. Soil permeability, drainage, water quality, farm size and location matter. Nor do trade-offs negate real livelihood and food-production gains.
- [VERDICT] The canal should be judged through a dashboard of yield stability, water-table depth, salinity, equity and native-ecosystem condition, not a success-versus-failure slogan.
- Why this earns marks: It presents benefits and costs, uses specific CGWB mechanisms and remedies, recognises spatial differentiation and supplies measurable evaluation criteria.

MAINS ANGLE

It presents benefits and costs, uses specific CGWB mechanisms and remedies, recognises spatial differentiation and supplies measurable evaluation criteria.

STUDY LINK

Original practice; not claimed as a UPSC PYQ.

HIGH**Original 20-marker 1 - Comprehensive desertification strategy**

20 marks | 250 words
Geography

NEWS TRIGGER

Original practice - examiner-oriented model answer using claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification -> verdict.

INTRO & ORIGIN

Evaluate the drivers of desertification in the Thar and design a process-matched restoration strategy consistent with Land Degradation Neutrality.

STATIC THEORY

- [CLAIM] Thar desertification emerges when natural dryland susceptibility is amplified by pressures that reduce cover, disturb soils, alter hydrology or weaken recovery institutions.
- [NAMED EVIDENCE] SAC's 2018-19 Atlas mapped 62.06% of Rajasthan under DLD and wind erosion over 43.37% of state TGA, while vegetation and water erosion were secondary. CGWB identifies waterlogging and salinity in susceptible IGNP pockets. CAZRI provides dune, shelterbelt, agroforestry and rangeland technologies; MoEFCC's 2023 NAP links the 26 mha by 2030 ambition to forestry, watershed and convergence measures; UNCCD requires Avoid-Reduce-Reverse.
- [ANALYSIS - DRIVERS] Erratic rain, wind energy, sandy or saline substrates and drought set susceptibility. Overgrazing concentrated by commons loss, vegetation removal, marginal cultivation, mining, roads, groundwater over-abstraction and poorly drained irrigation accelerate loss. Feedback follows when lower fodder and yields increase pressure on remaining land.
- [ANALYSIS - STRATEGY] Avoid fragmentation of intact pasture, dunes and Aravalli catchments. Reduce pressure through rotational grazing, crop-water fit, soil cover, efficient irrigation and regulated mining. Reverse damage with native grass-shrub dune stabilisation, khejri agroforestry, khadin-johad-chauka watershed work, pasture reseeding and drainage-conjunctive use in saline commands. Panchayats, pastoral groups, WUAs, state agencies and research institutions need defined maintenance roles.
- [QUALIFICATION] Tree cover is not the universal objective; natural open ecosystems and pastoral mobility require safeguards. The Atlas is a dated regional baseline, not proof of local causation.
- [VERDICT] Monitor land cover, productivity, soil carbon, wind erosion, water table, salinity, native survival, fodder and equity. LDN succeeds when avoided losses and restored function persist across drought cycles.
- Why this earns marks: It evaluates both natural and human drivers, uses five named evidence sources, applies the LDN hierarchy, assigns institutions, includes ecological safeguards and ends with indicators.

MAINS ANGLE

It evaluates both natural and human drivers, uses five named evidence sources, applies the LDN hierarchy, assigns institutions, includes ecological safeguards and ends with indicators.

STUDY LINK

Original practice; not claimed as a UPSC PYQ.

HIGH

Original 20-marker 2 - Dynamic Thar regional geography

20 marks | 250 words
Geography

NEWS TRIGGER

Original practice - examiner-oriented model answer using claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification -> verdict.

INTRO & ORIGIN

The Thar is a dynamic social-ecological region rather than a static desert. Analyse with reference to landforms, water, livelihoods and contemporary restoration.

STATIC THEORY

- [CLAIM] The Thar's identity comes from continuous interaction among wind-water processes, variable climate, human adaptation and modern infrastructure.

- [NAMED EVIDENCE] The sandy Marusthali, semi-arid Bagar margin, Luni drainage, playas and interdunes show physical diversity. Khejri agroforestry, bajra-pulse farming, tanka-khadin-johad systems and pastoral mobility show adaptation. IGNP created an irrigated northern frontier with both productivity gains and waterlogging-salinity risk. SAC maps changing degradation classes; CAZRI and the MoEFCC NAP promote dune, pasture, agroforestry and watershed restoration. The 2026 UNCCD rangelands agenda foregrounds pastoral institutions.

- [ANALYSIS] Dunes alternate between mobility and stability as wind, sediment, vegetation and disturbance change. Interdunes and playas convert episodic runoff into livelihood or salinity outcomes. Canal and groundwater access reorganise settlement and crops, while mining, renewable-energy corridors and roads can fragment commons and habitats. Institutions therefore mediate physical processes: grazing rules affect cover, WUAs affect canal outcomes and tenure affects restoration survival.

- [QUALIFICATION] Greening is not automatically restoration; higher biomass may coexist with falling groundwater, invasive spread or native-habitat loss. Origin theories remain contested and should not dominate a present-focused answer.

- [VERDICT] The Thar should be managed as a differentiated landscape whose success is sustained land function, water security, biodiversity and livelihood resilience - not the elimination of desert character.

- Why this earns marks: It integrates regional geography, processes, adaptation, infrastructure, institutions and current linkage while preserving the desert's ecological identity.

MAINS ANGLE

It integrates regional geography, processes, adaptation, infrastructure, institutions and current linkage while preserving the desert's ecological identity.

STUDY LINK

Original practice; not claimed as a UPSC PYQ.

End of Register Notes - UPSC Agent / Copilot CLI